nationalities in the process of administration. In a message to the nation, Karmal called upon all Afghans living abroad

to return to their homeland without fear of reprisals for past misdeeds, subject to the condition that they would no longer indulge in subversive activities.

The first week of October was marked by some reverses for the government in the Kunar province, which ultimately led to the suicide of the Central Corps commander, Major General Wadood. Since Wadood was a leading figure in the Khalq faction of the PDPA, it was feared that his death might lead to a further spate of violence and confrontation between the Khalq and Parcham factions.

There were intelligence reports about the increased flow of arms from Pakistan to the insurgents and the possibility of some insurgent leaders crossing to Afghanistan to provide active leadership to the rebels. According to reliable sources quoted in the reports, Soviet troops were deployed at the northern and southern ends of the Panj shir valley to spearhead attacks against insurgent forces.

In October 1982, the chief of KHAD, Dr Najibullah, sent the intelligence agency's spies to the villages to educate the people in favour of the government's programmes and policies. Insurgent activities continued unabated all over the country throughout November and December 1982, affecting Herat, Kandahar, Jalalabad and Mazar-e-Sharif in particular. There was an increase in violence in urban centres including Kabul and frequent attacks by rebels on convoys on the highways. Reports indicated that the rebels had acquired more sophisticated equipment as well as better medical supplies. According to Afghan intelligence sources, the total number of insurgents was